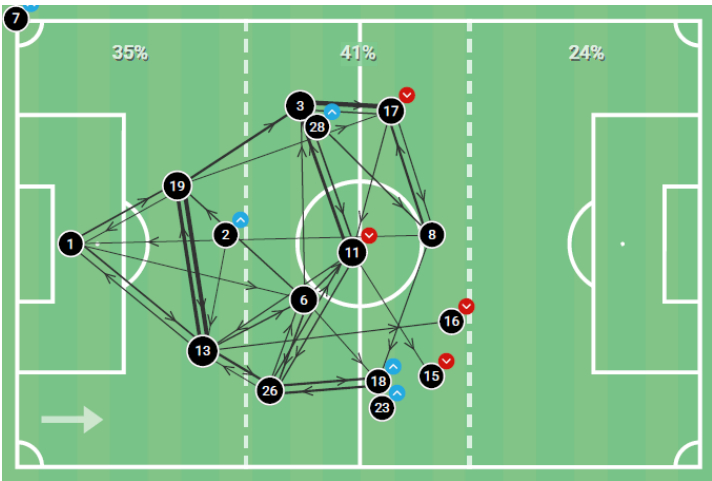


# LEAD OPPONENT SCOUTING REPORT

**Opponent:** Northwestern Wildcats  
**Date of Match:** 11/04  
**Compiled By:** Soham Mukherjee  
**Opponent Record:** 7-5-3 in Fall 2025 (most recently 2-0 win vs Indiana)

**Overall Team Overview (over conference games):**

Northwestern plays with a balanced approach, using short to medium passes to build through midfield and going long when space opens up. Their central midfielders, #6 and #8 (left-footed), link defense to attack with sharp passes through gaps or through combinations in wide areas to release wingers. #8, physically imposing with slower movement, often draws pressure before releasing teammates into space. Most of their open-play goals stem from passing sequences dictated by #8 or direct balls toward #16 (ST), who looks to knock down for runners like #18 (4 G, 2 A) and #17 (2 G, 5 A). Attacking corners usually taken by #8 target #13, #6, and #26, often aiming for a back-post header knocked across goal for a tap-in. Defensively, Northwestern are vulnerable when losing possession high up the field, as opponents exploit open spaces with quick transitions. They also struggled on set pieces, conceding 5 of their last 9 goals from dead-ball situations (2 penalties). Their defensive shape with two strikers pressing high while midfielders sit deeper, leaves exploitable space between the lines. Once past the front two, opponents can play through with a numbers advantage or attack around the flanks (both fullbacks have recorded 100+ ball losses).



Passing matrix vs Penn State

|                           |       |                                                                                           |
|---------------------------|-------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PPDA                      | 13.31 | The front two apply pressure while the midfield line defends deeper, closer to back four. |
| Average Possession %      | 43.24 | Tend to be dominated and concede control when opponents dictate tempo/possession.         |
| Passes per Possession     | 2.99  | Favors medium-length passes with a forward bias, using long balls as outlets.             |
| Progressive Passes per 90 | 69    | High volume of progressive pass attempts but accuracy is inconsistent (64% accuracy)      |
| xG per 90                 | 1.07  | Moderate attacking output with reliance on direct or transitional play.                   |

**In Possession:**

- Shape: 4-4-2 or 4-2-3-1
- During buildup, #8 drops deep to receive and combine with others, fullbacks high and wide
- Key attacking patterns: combination plays to release wingers; runs into space off knockdowns from long balls

**Out of Possession:**

- Shape: 4-4-2 with mid to high block
- Moderate press (PPDA ~13.31) with a high front 2 but deeper midfield line
- Vulnerable in defensive transitions, slow to get numbers back
- Space to exploit between lines and targeting wide areas for penetration

**Key Players:**

- #8 – Joe Suchecki (CM)
  - Composed, technical on ball
  - Drops deep during buildup, joins attack with late runs
- #18 – Aaron O'Reilly (ST)
  - Leading goalscorer (4)
  - Reliable finisher, deployed as a target man or CAM